



CS-467- Software Project Management

Lecture No. 3

Software Project Planning

List of Topic to be Discuss in this lecture

- Initiating the project
- Identifying the Project Purpose
- What is Stakeholder?
- Talking To the Stakeholders
- Levels of Organization
- Project Charter
- What is project stakeholder management?
- Levels of engagement

Initiating the project

- The first process group is initiation.
- At the initiation stage, the PM must make an effort to understand the reasons the project is necessary.
- Empathizing with the project customer (the person paying for the project) and the key stakeholders now can help you stay on track later.
- Knowing why the project is being created will help you ask the right questions to help the customer get to the desired solution.

Identifying the Project Purpose

- **Why is the project being initiated?** You first have to know the project purpose.
- **Does everyone agree on this purpose and goals?** There must be consensus on what the project will create. There must be consensus on of the project. If not, you can count on trouble before the project is complete.

What is Stakeholder?

Individuals, groups, or organizations who may affect, be affected by, or perceive themselves to be affected by a decision, activity, or outcome of a project. The table below identifies some of the people who might be stakeholders in your job or in your projects:

Your boss	Shareholders	Government
Senior executives	Alliance partners	Trades associations
Your co-workers	Suppliers	The press
Your team	Lenders	Interest groups
Customers	Analysts	The public
Prospective customers	Future recruits	The community
Your family	Key contributors	Key advisors

Three Stakeholder Categories

- ✓ What project managers must remember when identifying stakeholders is that it is not just a list of the names of those directly working on the project.
- ✓ It takes careful consideration of the scope and depth of a project's potential outcomes (**positive** or **negative**) to accurately capture impacted organizations, groups, and individuals.
- ✓ Project Managers should conduct research to **identify** and **understand** potential stakeholders. Examples of three stakeholder categories are:

Organizations	Groups	Individuals
• <i>Government Agency</i> • <i>Union</i> • <i>Regulatory Body</i> • <i>Company Audit Dept</i>	• <i>Creditors</i> • <i>Shareholders</i> • <i>Suppliers</i> • <i>Community</i>	• <i>CEO</i> • <i>Director of IT Security</i> • <i>Project Manager</i> • <i>Investor</i>

Talking To the Stakeholders

There are five questions every project manager should ask stakeholders:

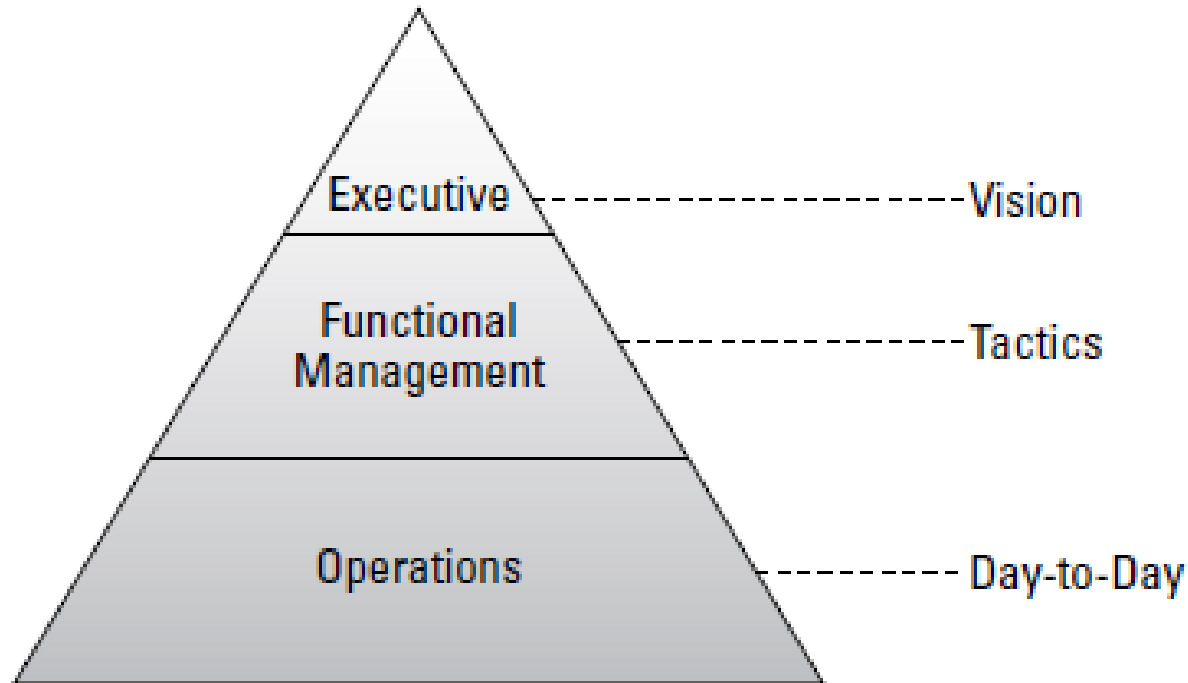
- **What are the factors for completion?** You should ask this key question far in advance of starting the project work. As a project manager you need to know what the project will accomplish and be able to plan how to get there. If the qualifications for completion are unknown or fuzzy at best, you're not ready to get to work. Starting a project without knowing what the end result should be is like building a house without blueprints.
- **What is the goal/objective of this project?** Knowing the project's goal helps you and the team plan. For some projects the goal will be to win new customers, or to make internal processes more efficient, or to solve a problem. Other projects may be financially based. For example, the goal maybe to create this essential transition to VoIP without spending more than\$235,000.

Talking To the Stakeholders

- **What are the areas of the organization that this project will affect?** The answer to this question tells you who you need to communicate with. It also brings to attention that there may be stakeholders who aren't attending meetings and should be. Although it's easy to identify the end-users of your software, there may be “hidden stakeholders” to consider: accounting, security personnel, government agencies, a training team, and so on.
- **What is the project priority?** Chances are good you'll be managing more than one project at a time, and there are equal chances that your project team members will be on multiple projects as well. When you consider these odds it's best to know your priorities so you know where to spend your energy.
- **What is the accepted range of variance?** The range of variance is the +/- value associated with the budget and the schedule. For example, a project may have a budget of \$450,000, +45,000 to -\$25,000. This means the project could actually cost as much as \$495,000 or as little as \$425,000. You can actually apply the same methods to the project schedule. This nugget of info can help you plan and react to problems within the project—and you know there'll be problems.

Levels of Organization

Each level of your organization has different needs, different concerns, and different goals for your project. You need to address each level of your organization to get the project moving to completion



Talking To the Executives

Executives are responsible for setting the vision and direction of their organization. This small group of people (or sometimes even a single person) has a vision for the organization and is interested in taking herself and her employees there.

Questions you need to ask executives.

- What are the factors for project success?
- What's your vision for the project result?
- What's more important, time or budget?
- What risks do you anticipate for this project's success?

Talking To the Functional Management

In the middle of the pyramid are all the folks who comprise functional management. You may know this layer as middle management. Their purpose is to carry out the vision of the executives. It's at this level of the organization that tactics, strategy, and delivery of purpose to the employees take place.

Questions you'll need to ask functional managers:

- What are the factors for project success?
- Are there scheduling issues that will affect the project's end date?
- What resources are available for the software creation?
- What departments and customers will need to interact?
- How will the project team be assembled?
- Do you have a preset budget in mind for the project?
- What risks do you see for this project?

Talking To the Operations

Down deep in the pyramid you'll find operations. These are the people that do the work. The people in operations focus on the day-to-day activities of getting things done.

Questions you'll need to ask to the operations:

- What are the factors for project success?
- How will the software be used?
- What other software projects are you working on now?
- What immediate risks do you see in the project?
- Who has the experience to get this done?
- Do we need training to create this software?
- What areas of the project are you dreading?

Project Charter

- A project charter is a **short document** used in project planning to outline the key aims and benefits of a project.
- It's an **at-a-glance guide** to why a project is taking place. It's used both as a marketing tool, useful to get buy-in from stakeholders, and a **reference point** to keep the project on track.
- A project charter document describes a project to create a **shared understanding** of its **goals**, **objectives** and **resource requirements** before the project is scoped out in detail.

What is project stakeholder management?

- **Identify** the people, groups, or organizations that could impact or be impacted by the project
- To **analyze** stakeholder expectations and their impact on the project.
- To **develop** appropriate management strategies for effectively engaging stakeholders.

Stakeholder Register

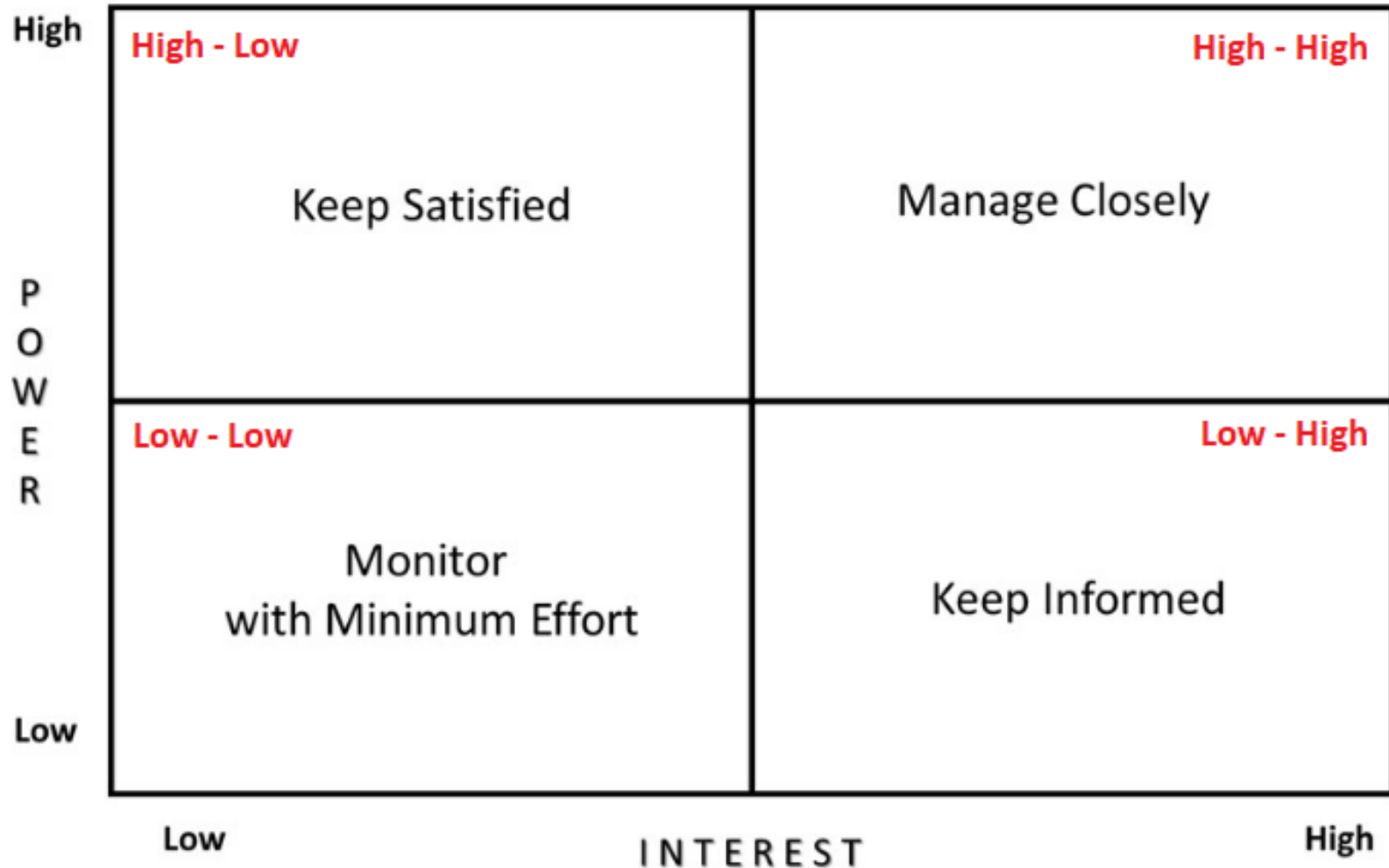
“Stakeholder Register” is the term used by PMI® for the documentation tool that captures your stakeholder information. At the basic level, the Stakeholder Register is described as: **A project documentation including the identification, assessment and classification of project stakeholders.**

Stakeholder Register

Project Manager		Project Phase				
Anthony Daukes		Initiation				
Role	Contact	Category	Interest	Influence	Expectations	Comms requirements
Sponsor	Phone: +61 4834467651 Email: john.matthew@gmail.com	Internal	● ● ●	● ● ●	User friendly and responsive UI across handheld device, tablet or desktop	Video Conference and Email
Project Lead	Phone: +61 4785739580 Email: luke.wilson@gmail.com	Internal	● ● ●	○ ● ●	Project to be delivered on time within budget	Email and Telephone
Product Manager	Phone: +91 9923535534 Email: deepak.patel@gmail.com	Internal	○ ● ●	○ ○ ●	Clear Requirements and timely completion of documentation	Email and Telephone
PMO	Phone: +65 8542533152 Email: suzie.barker@gmail.com	Internal	○ ● ●	○ ○ ●	Project to be delivered on time within budget Timely approvals to be obtained	Email and Telephone
Dev Manager	Phone: +44 5871512134 Email: thomas.atkins@gmail.com	Internal	○ ● ●	○ ● ●	Develop responsive UI	Email and Telephone
QA Manager	Phone: +91 9852425634 Email: disha.sharma@gmail.com	Internal	○ ● ●	○ ● ●	UI is responsive No quality issues Branding is maintained	Email and Telephone
Infrastructure Team Lead	Phone: +61 4854865621 Email: iim.arthur@gmail.com	Internal	○ ● ●	○ ○ ●	Changes should not affect the uptime of the system	Email and Telephone

Prioritize Your Stakeholders

You can map out your stakeholders, and classify them according to their power over your work and their interest in it, on a Power/Interest Grid as follows.



Prioritize Your Stakeholders

The position that you allocate to a stakeholder on the grid shows you the actions you need to take with them:

1.High power – High interest: These stakeholders are decision-makers and have the biggest impact on the project's success and hence we must **closely manage** their expectations. We should work closely with them to ensure that they agree with and support the change. The project sponsor, project manager, and the team can be included in this quadrant.

2.High power – Low Interest: These stakeholders need to be **kept satisfied** even though they aren't interested because they yield power. This type of stakeholders should be dealt with cautiously as well since they may use their power in a not desired way in the project if they become unsatisfied. Government and regulatory agencies which inspect the quality of your work in compliance with legal provisions and standards can be included in this quadrant.

3.Low power – High interest: We should keep these stakeholders adequately **informed** and talk to them to ensure that no major issues are arising. They are likely to be very concerned and may feel anxious about a lack of control. They can often be very helpful with the detail of your project. Our customers or end-users who are willing to purchase the outcome of the project (e.g., a product or a service) can be included in this quadrant.

4.Low power – Low interest: We should **monitor** these stakeholders, but do not bore them with excessive communication. The public and the customers who are not willing to purchase our products can be included in this quadrant. We can send them newsletters once every month, but not every week. We should monitor their interest and power level in case they may change.

Levels of Engagement

This Analytical techniques means figuring out how engaged your stakeholders are today, and how engaged you want them to be as your project gets under way. The levels of engagement are:

1. **Unaware:** The stakeholder does not know that the project is happening.
2. **Resistant:** The stakeholder does not want the project or decision you are making to happen.
3. **Neutral:** The stakeholder is fine with the project or decision no matter how it turns out.
4. **Supportive:** The stakeholder wants your project or decision to succeed.
5. **Leading:** The stakeholder is actively helping the project to succeed.

Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder Register With Power/Interest Grid Status and Level of Engagement

Name	Job Title	Contact	Categeory	Expectation	Communication Requirement	Power/Interest Grid Status	Levels of Engagement
Qasim	Project Lead	Phone: 03332244768 Email:Qasim78@gmail.com	Internal	Project to be delivered on time within budget	Email and Tel	Keep Satisfied	Leading